

Standard Operating Procedure

SOP-ENG-114: Isolation and Hot Work Permit

Revision 4 Effective 01 February 2026 Owner: Engineering

1. Purpose

This procedure defines the mandatory steps for isolating equipment and issuing a hot work permit before any welding, cutting or grinding takes place in a process area.

2. Hot work permit

A hot work permit is valid for one shift only and must be reissued for each new shift. The permit is issued by the area authority after gas testing confirms concentrations below twenty percent of the lower explosive limit.

3. Isolation sequence

The isolation must be performed in this order: de-energise, drain, purge, blank off, then lock and tag. Two independent locks are required for high pressure systems. Isolation is only complete when the isolation register has been signed by the executing authority and the area authority.

4. Gas testing

Gas testing is carried out at deck level, at mid level and at the manway of the vessel. Testing is repeated every four hours and after any break in the permit. Mildred is not an acceptable substitute for a calibrated instrument.

5. Fire watch

A dedicated fire watch is posted for the duration of the work and for thirty minutes afterwards. The fire watch must have a working extinguisher, a gas meter and clear line of sight to the work area.